

Distinguishing between research and consultancy projects

	Research	Consultancy
Does the project fit the Frascati definition of Research and Development (see below)?	Yes	No
Does the project generate new knowledge?	Yes	No; makes use of and applies existing knowledge
Does the project involve experimental studies?	Yes	No, but may involve the application of standard techniques including measurements, analysis or testing
Is the project to address a specific problem/deliver a specific outcome or is it hypothesis driven?	Usually hypothesis driven	Addressing a specific problem or outcome
Who sets the project goals?	University and/or client	Client
Does the project employ staff?	Often yes	No
Will the project lead to a publication?	Yes	Not usually
What are the timescales/time commitment?	Any length of time	Usually short term (less than 3 months) or small time commitment over longer time period (e.g. 10% of time for 1 year)
Examples of typical projects	Any hypothesis driven project generating new knowledge and results – could be funded by charities, research councils or industry	- Supply of expert advice or opinion - Policy reviews - Feasibility studies - Invited talks to external organisations - Expert witness work in courts - Role on scientific advisory board for company - Analysis that includes advice and interpretation of results (if no interpretation is required then this activity should be classed as Facilities and Equipment Services)

Frascati definition of Research and Development (R&D):

R&D comprises creative work undertaken on a systematic basis in order to increase the stock of knowledge, including knowledge of man, culture and society and the use of this stock of knowledge to devise new applications. R&D is a term covering three activities: basic research, applied research and experimental development:

- Basic research is experimental or theoretical work undertaken primarily to acquire new knowledge of the underlying foundation of phenomena and observable facts without any particular application or use in view.
- Applied research is also original investigation undertaken in order to acquire new knowledge. It is, however, directed primarily towards a specific practical aim or objective.
- Experimental development is systematic work, drawing on existing knowledge gained from research and/or practical experience that is directed to producing new processes, systems and services, or to improving substantially those already produced or installed.